

Standard Operating Procedure (SOP): Demonstration Project Management

Foundation for California Community Colleges

Success Center – Strategic Policy, Innovation and Research (SPIR) Unit

1. Purpose

This Standard Operating Procedure (SOP) defines the standardized process for initiating, managing, reporting, and closing **Demonstration Projects (DPs)**.

The SOP ensures consistency, transparency, and alignment with Vision 2030 goals by outlining key operational steps, roles, and reporting expectations for all internal project leads and supporting staff.

2. Scope

This SOP applies to all Demonstration Projects overseen by the California Community Colleges Chancellor's Office (CCCCO) and supported by the Success Center's Strategic Policy, Innovation and Research Unit.

It is intended for use by project leads, managers, and the Demonstration Project Specialist, who collectively ensure each project's operational success and compliance with established standards.

3. Roles and Responsibilities

Role Responsibilities

<i>Project Sponsor ("Accountable")</i>	Accountable for the overall outcomes of the project and decisions along the way.
<i>Project Lead ("Responsible")</i>	Oversees project execution, manages stakeholder communication, and ensures deliverables are met according to schedule and scope.
<i>Project Support</i>	Responsible for providing key insights and/or delivering key activities within the project.
<i>Demonstration Project Specialist</i>	Provides operational, logistical, and reporting support throughout all phases of the project lifecycle, including setup, data coordination, and closeout. Identifies synergies across demonstration projects and ensures alignment with Vision 2030 goals and systemwide priorities.

Data Liaison (CCCCO)	Supports metrics development, tracking, and reporting accuracy for project KPIs.
Partners and Stakeholders	Collaborate on project goals, provide data, and contribute deliverables and insights.

4. Standard Process Overview

All Demonstration Projects follow a consistent four-phase operational structure. Each phase includes specific steps, documentation, and deliverables supported by the Demonstration Project Specialist.

Phase 1: Initiation and Engagement (Planning)

Objective:

To establish foundational structure, documentation, and access for new Demonstration Projects.

Key Steps:

1. Designation:

The lifecycle begins once a project has been internally designated as a Demonstration Project (DP) by CCCCCO leadership.

Projects typically fall into one of two categories:

- An existing stream of work elevated to DP status, or
- A new concept developed from inception.

2. Kickoff and Documentation:

A kickoff call is scheduled with CO Leadership, the Demonstration Project Specialist and the Project Lead(s) to confirm project goals, scope, and deliverables.

The project lead completes two key foundational documents:

- Project Development Template
- RACI Document
 - Templates will be provided by the Demonstration Project Specialist and can be accessed in the Project Folder within the Vision 2030 SharePoint repository.

3. Operational Setup:

- The **Vision 2030 Project Management SharePoint** serves as the official repository for all Demonstration Projects, fostering transparency and collaboration. Each Demonstration Project has its own folder.
- The Demonstration Project Specialist creates a dedicated project folder with standard subfolders for *reporting*, *artifacts*, and *metrics*.
- Access is granted as follows:
 - “A” (Accountable/Sponsor) members: full SharePoint access.

- “R” (Responsible/Lead) members: access to assigned project folder only.

Deliverables:

- Completed Project Development Template and RACI Document
 - SharePoint project folder created and shared
 - Kickoff notes and confirmation email
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Phase 2: Activation and Integration (Onboarding)**Objective:**

To officially onboard the project as a Demonstration Project and establish performance tracking mechanisms.

Key Steps:**1. BOG Presentation:**

- The Project team has two options to “officially” present their project to the BOG:
 - OPTION 1: The project may be introduced to the Board of Governors (BOG) as an informational item.
 - OPTION 2: The project may be included in the July BOG report.
- While not an approval process, this presentation or update in the BOG report formally places the project on record.

2. Metrics Development:

- The Demonstration Project Specialist shares the Metrics Phase I Form with the project lead, who completes it within three weeks.
- The Specialist then pre-fills the Metrics Phase II Template to prepare for data integration.
- A one-hour meeting is scheduled with the CCCCCO Data Lead, who assigns a Data Liaison to support metrics and KPI tracking.

Deliverables:

- Completed Metrics Phase I Form
 - Metrics Phase II Form prepared
 - Data Liaison assigned
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Phase 3: Progress Tracking and Continuous Assessment (Reporting)**Objective:**

To monitor project progress, document outcomes, and maintain transparent reporting cycles.

Key Steps:**1. Quarterly Reporting:**

- Each Demonstration Project submits two reports per quarter:

- **Midterm Report:** Focuses on highlights, key activities, and project support.
- **Quarterly Report:** A comprehensive update that includes RACI, V2030 outcomes, college participants, quarterly activities, artifacts, metrics, and next steps.
- Due dates for each report are found here: [DP Report Schedule 2026](#)

2. **Template Distribution and Submission:**

- The Demonstration Project Specialist creates report templates and uploads them to each project's SharePoint folder.
- The Specialist provides email notifications when templates are ready (also noted in the reporting calendar) and reminders one week before each deadline.
- Leads complete reports by designated due dates.

3. **Ongoing Support:**

- The Specialist offers technical assistance and can schedule check-in meetings to review progress, resolve challenges, and align on next steps.

Deliverables:

- Completed Midterm and Quarterly Reports
- Updated metrics and KPI tracking in collaboration with Data Liaison
- Archived reports in SharePoint

Phase 4: Reflection and Learning (Closeout)

Objective:

To finalize documentation, capture lessons learned, and determine the project's transition or completion status.

Key Steps:

1. **Determine Next Steps:**

- In collaboration with CO leadership, the project lead identifies whether the project will:
 - **Scale Out** – expand to new colleges or initiatives.
 - **Transition** – evolve into a new phase or merge with another Demonstration Project.
 - **Close Out** – conclude its demonstration phase.

2. **Closeout Documentation and Executive Presentation:**

- The project lead completes the Closeout Form summarizing outcomes, goals achieved, and key insights.
- The Demonstration Project Specialist schedules a closeout meeting to review the documentation and discuss next steps.
- The project lead schedules a presentation to showcase project findings to the CO executive team.

3. **Archiving and Knowledge Transfer:**

- All final reports and deliverables are uploaded to the project's SharePoint folder and archived under "Closeout."
- Lessons learned are summarized for institutional learning and reference.

Deliverables:

- Completed Closeout Form
 - Presentation to CO Exec team
 - Closeout meeting notes
 - Archived final project folder
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5. Tools and Templates

All Demonstration Project resources are stored in the Vision 2030 Project Management SharePoint under the "Resources" section.

This includes:

- Project Development Template
 - RACI Document
 - Metrics Phase I and II Forms
 - Midterm and Quarterly Report Templates
 - Closeout Form
 - Reporting Calendar
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6. Reporting and Review Cycle

- Demonstration Project reports are submitted twice per quarter per the official reporting calendar.
 - This SOP is reviewed bi-annually by CO leadership and the Demonstration Project Specialist to ensure it reflects current operational practices and aligns with evolving priorities.
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7. Contacts

For questions or support regarding Demonstration Project operations, reporting, or documentation, contact the Demonstration Project Specialist via email at squezada-acosta@foundationccc.org